Rebellion as news came through of Gandhi's arrival in Srinagar the previous day.

Gandhi arrived in Srinagar on 1 August 1947 by road via Rawalpindi. According to A. M. Watali, who retired in 1987 as the IG of the valley and who, as a teenager, was an eyewitness, Gandhi arrived in a convertible whose hood was drawn down. Thousands of people had collected in what is now the Batamaloo bus stand, and the crowd continued up to where the Badshah Bridge now stands. From the bus stand till the Old Secretariat, and right up to the Maharaja's palace on Gupkar Road, there was a sea of people. They were only shouting one slogan, '*Baghi Abdullah ki jai*', 'All Hail, Abdullah!' Watali saw Gandhi covering his ears because the reverberations of this continuous chant were too uncomfortable to bear. It was a spontaneous upsurge of popular support for Abdullah. A visibly moved Gandhi experienced personally the kind of popular support that Abdullah enjoyed in the valley. But was Gandhi aware that this volume of public support for Abdullah was only restricted to the valley?

With great difficulty, the driver of Gandhi's car drove him to the house of Seth Kishorilal in the Barzulla suburb of Srinagar, where he was to stay. Later in the evening, around 5:00 PM, Gandhi drove up to the palace and met with the Maharaja and the Maharani.[17]He appeared to have impressed upon the Maharaja to release Sheikh Abdullah from prison, remove Kak from his position and swiftly make up his mind about accession. As dusk descended, the palace and the city were celebrating the return of the Gilgit Agency to the rule of the Maharaja. Gandhi, it appeared, frowned on this celebration and curiously observed and prophesied that the Gilgit Agency would ultimately be snatched away. Gandhi's curious observations only underscored his knowledge of what was brewing in the highlands. However, Mountbatten, Nehru and Patel were helpless unless the Maharaja acted.

Hari Singh turned a deaf ear to Gandhi's foreboding on the Gilgit Agency, finding false comfort in Maj. Gen. Scott, Premier Kak and Brig. Ghansara Singh's assurances. Hari Singh never granted any of Gandhi's wishes and never issued orders to release Abdullah from prison. Nehru and